

## FOR THE TEACHER

# Teacher Guide & Answer Key



Hallucination Hunters — every planted error with the true fact, second-source key, verdict guidance, exit ticket key, what to do when it goes sideways, standards map.

## WHY THIS LESSON

Every AI job runs **human** → **AI** → **human**: a person starts it (the prompt) and a person ends it (the check). This lesson trains the second human job. The core insight students leave with: AI predicts *likely* words, not *verified* words — so smoothness is zero evidence of truth. Lateral reading (leave the answer, confirm against a second, independent source) is the move fact-checkers are taught; it works on AI answers, group-chat rumors, and feeds alike. Stands alone.

## ANSWER KEY — WARM-UP PARAGRAPH (READ-ALOUD)

| PLANTED ERROR                                                        | THE TRUE FACT                                                                                                                                         |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| "The closest planet to the Sun is Venus, which is also the hottest." | <b>Mercury</b> is closest to the Sun. Venus really is the hottest (its thick atmosphere traps heat) — the half-truth is what makes this one slippery. |
| "Saturn... is the only planet in our solar system that has [rings]." | Jupiter, Uranus, and Neptune also have rings — faint ones. Saturn's are just the most visible.                                                        |

*True claims a desk should mark SAFE or confirm:* eight planets; Mars is red from rusty iron dust on its surface; sunlight takes about eight minutes to reach Earth.

## WHEN IT GOES SIDeways

**A desk asks "is this one true?"** → "That's a checkable claim — where's your second source?" Play the editor, not the answer key; keep deadline energy ("Presses roll in five!").

**The trusting desk clears everything** ("it sounded right") → send them back to step 1: "Did you underline the dates and names? Start there." Every draft has at least one wrong date or name.

**The paranoid desk kills everything** ("it's all suspicious") → that's what RANK is for: "Which claim would hurt most if wrong? Check that one first." The goal is calibrated doubt, not panic.

**A desk treats the Draft #3 quote as proof** ("it's in quotation marks") → the boss level. Desk rule: a quote is a claim — no traceable source, no print. Expect some students to need this said twice.

## DISCUSSION QUESTIONS (DEBRIEF, OR THE NEXT DAY)

- Most of the room voted to print the warm-up paragraph. What made it *feel* true? (Smooth sentences, confident tone, real-sounding details.)
- Why is a fabricated quote more dangerous than a wrong date? (A date is easy to check; a quote borrows a real person's credibility.)
- Marcus's ending was an opinion built on a false fact. Can an opinion be "wrong"? (It can be unsupported — when the evidence under it fails, so does the argument.)

## ANSWER KEY — THE THREE DRAFTS (GROUPED BY DRAFT)

| DRAFT     | PLANTED ERROR                                                                     | THE TRUE FACT                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|-----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| #1 Priya  | "Astronauts first landed on the Moon in 1959"                                     | The first crewed Moon landing was Apollo 11, in <b>1969</b> . (Pushback to expect: the uncrewed probe <i>Luna 2</i> reached the Moon in 1959 — but no astronauts landed. "Astronauts landed" is still false.)                        |
| #1 Priya  | "the Moon... produces its own light"                                              | The Moon makes no light of its own — it <b>reflects sunlight</b> .                                                                                                                                                                   |
| #1 Priya  | Ending: "the brightest thing in the night sky"                                    | <b>True claim, false reason.</b> The Moon <b>IS</b> the brightest night-sky object — but because it reflects sunlight, not because it makes light. The argument breaks even though the ending is right. Verdict: <b>FIX</b> .        |
| #2 Theo   | "Mount Everest... rises in the Andes range in South America"                      | Everest is in the <b>Himalayas, in Asia</b> . The Andes are in South America.                                                                                                                                                        |
| #2 Theo   | "Australia's capital city is Sydney"                                              | The capital is <b>Canberra</b> , not Sydney — a classic mix-up.                                                                                                                                                                      |
| #2 Theo   | Ending: "record-holders sit on three continents: Africa, South America, and Asia" | Once Everest moves back to Asia, South America holds none of the passage's records, so the ending no longer follows. Verdict: <b>FIX</b> .                                                                                           |
| #3 Marcus | "Thomas Edison invented the telephone in 1876"                                    | <b>Alexander Graham Bell</b> patented the telephone in 1876. Edison's fame rests on the phonograph and practical electric lighting.                                                                                                  |
| #3 Marcus | Quote: "The telephone is the finest of all my inventions."                        | <b>Fabricated</b> — written for this exercise; it has no source. AI can generate real-sounding quotes nobody said. No traceable source = no print.                                                                                   |
| #3 Marcus | Ending: "Edison's record makes him the most important inventor of the 1800s"      | An opinion propped up by a false fact (Edison did not invent the telephone) and an invented quote. Strip those and the claim is unsupported. Verdict: <b>KILL</b> the ending; the true phonograph and Wright brothers facts survive. |

*True claims, safe to confirm:* #1 — the Moon is Earth's only natural satellite; Neil Armstrong walked first; by 1972, twelve people had walked on the Moon (six Apollo landings). #2 — the Pacific is the largest ocean; the Nile flows north through Egypt and is one of the world's longest rivers; seven continents (seven in the model US schools use); Asia is the largest. #3 — the phonograph (1877) was the first machine to both record and play back sound; the Wright brothers made the first sustained, controlled powered flights in 1903 near Kitty Hawk, North Carolina — the widely accepted record (rival "first flight" claims exist, so a desk that marks it C is doing the job; confirm and print).

## VERDICT GUIDANCE + EXEMPLAR NOTE

Draft #1 — **FIX** (topic holds; correct the date and the light claim). Draft #2 — **FIX** (correct the range and the capital). Draft #3 — **KILL the ending, keep the true facts** (headline claim false, supporting quote fabricated). No draft earns RUN today; tell the class that's realistic. A well-argued FIX on #3 ("rewrite it about Bell") earns credit for evidence — then ask: is that a fix, or a new story? Score the evidence, not the stamp.

**Exemplar note to Priya (proficient):** "Two things are wrong: astronauts landed in 1969, not 1959, and the Moon doesn't make light — it reflects sunlight. Second source: NASA's Apollo 11 page. Your ending still stands (it **IS** the brightest), but the reason has to change." Partial: one error named, no second source. No credit: a stamp with no evidence.

## KEY — “SECOND SOURCE: WHERE I’D CHECK IT” COLUMN

The ISTE 1.3.b item. Full credit: a specific KIND of source, independent of the draft and of the AI. Partial: "look it up online." No credit: asked the AI again; "Google" with no site named; the draft itself.

| DRAFT         | ACCEPTABLE SECOND SOURCES                                                                                                                                                                                                    | WHAT FAILS                                                                              |
|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| #1 Moon       | A space-agency page (NASA) on Apollo 11 or the Moon; an encyclopedia entry "Moon"; a science textbook's astronomy chapter.                                                                                                   | "Ask the AI if it's sure"; a video that repeats the claim; "Google" with no site named. |
| #2 Records    | An atlas or globe; an encyclopedia entry on Everest or Australia; a geography textbook; the Australian government's own site.                                                                                                | A quiz site that copied the claim; a friend who "knows"; the draft itself.              |
| #3 Inventions | An encyclopedia entry on Bell, Edison, or the telephone; a museum site (Smithsonian); a history textbook. For the quote: a collection of Edison's writings or a quotation reference — nothing turns up, so it has no source. | "It's in quotation marks, so it's real"; asking the AI "did Edison say this?"           |

## 🔍 EXIT TICKET KEY

**#1 — How can AI sound 100% sure and still be wrong?** Full credit names the mechanism: AI predicts the *likely next words*; it doesn't check them against anything. Confidence is a writing style, not evidence. Accept "it guesses what sounds right" or "it's a smooth talker, not a fact-checker." Partial credit: "it makes mistakes" with no why.

**#2 — A real checkable claim + a second source that is NOT where they first saw it.** Full credit names a claim with a name, date, number, place, or quote in it AND a specific second source ("the NASA site, not the video that made the claim"; "the team's official schedule"; "a news site that didn't copy the first one"). Partial: "Google it" with no source named — push back: "Google shows you ten sources. Which one, and why that one?" No credit: "ask the AI again."

## FULL STANDARDS TEXT

- **CCSS ELA RI.6.8** — Trace and evaluate the argument and specific claims in a text, distinguishing claims that are supported by reasons and evidence from claims that are not. *Taught: Fact-desk method steps 1 and 4 (underline claims; test the ending). Assessed: the RUN/FIX/KILL stamp + note on each draft ("does the ending still stand?").*
- **ISTE 1.3.b** — Students evaluate the accuracy, perspective, credibility and relevance of information, media, data or other resources. *Taught: lateral reading, step 3. Assessed: the "Second source" column on each draft (key above) + Exit Ticket #2.*
- **ISTE 1.3.d** — Students build knowledge by actively exploring real-world issues and problems, developing ideas and theories and pursuing answers and solutions. *Taught: The Fact Desk activity — desks pursue verification and defend verdicts in "Verdicts out loud." Assessed: Exit Ticket #2 (a real claim from their own week, and where they would check it).*

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